

Verdant Peak Technologies - IT Policies

Verdant Peak Technologies — IT Policies

1. Purpose

This IT Policies document sets out the rules governing the use of Verdant Peak Technologies (VPT) information systems, devices, networks, and data. It applies to every employee, contractor, and third party who is granted access to VPT's technology environment. Compliance with these policies is mandatory and is a condition of continued system access; violations may result in disciplinary action up to termination and, where applicable, legal action.

2. Acceptable Use of Company Systems

VPT-provided systems, including laptops, email accounts, and internal applications, are intended primarily for business purposes. Limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work duties, consume excessive bandwidth, or violate any other Company policy. Employees must not use Company systems to access, store, or distribute illegal content, pirated software, or material that violates the Code of Conduct (including harassing, discriminatory, or sexually explicit content). All activity on Company systems may be monitored and logged in accordance with applicable law, and employees should have no expectation of privacy when using Company-owned devices or accounts.

3. Device Management

All employees are issued a Company laptop upon joining, enrolled in the Mobile Device Management (MDM) platform, which enforces disk encryption, automatic security updates, and remote wipe capability in case of loss or theft. Personal devices used to access Company email or applications (Bring Your Own Device, or BYOD) must be enrolled in the MDM's BYOD profile, which enforces a minimum passcode policy and allows selective remote wipe of Company data only. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to the IT Service Desk within 4 hours of discovery so that remote wipe and access revocation can be triggered immediately.

4. Password and Authentication Standards

All Company accounts require a minimum password length of 14 characters, including at least one uppercase letter, one number, and one special character. Passwords must be changed every 180 days and may not be reused for the previous 10 passwords. Multi-Factor

Authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all Company systems, including email, VPN, and internal applications, using the approved Authenticator app. Sharing passwords or authentication credentials with any other person, including colleagues and managers, is strictly prohibited under all circumstances.

5. Data Classification and Handling

VPT classifies data into four tiers: **Public** (approved for external release), **Internal** (for employee use only, e.g., internal memos), **Confidential** (business-sensitive, e.g., financial forecasts, customer contracts), and **Restricted** (highly sensitive, e.g., employee PII, source code, security credentials). Confidential and Restricted data must never be stored on personal devices, personal cloud storage (e.g., personal Google Drive or Dropbox), or transmitted via personal email accounts. All Restricted data must be encrypted both at rest and in transit, and access is granted strictly on a need-to-know basis, reviewed quarterly by system owners.

6. Email and Communication Security

Employees must exercise caution with unsolicited emails and attachments and are required to complete quarterly phishing simulation training; employees who fail three consecutive simulations are enrolled in mandatory remedial security training. Suspected phishing emails should be reported using the “Report Phishing” button in Outlook, which forwards the email to the Security Operations Center (SOC) for analysis. Auto-forwarding of Company email to personal or external email addresses is disabled by default and may not be re-enabled without Security team approval.

7. Software Installation and Licensing

Employees may not install unauthorized or unlicensed software on Company devices. All software requests must be submitted through the IT Service Catalog and are reviewed for security and licensing compliance before approval, typically within 3 working days. Open-source software used in Company products must be reviewed and approved by the Engineering Architecture team to ensure license compatibility, in accordance with the internal Open Source Usage Guidelines.

8. Remote Access and VPN

Employees connecting to internal Company resources from outside the office network must use the Company-approved VPN client, which enforces MFA and device compliance checks before granting access. Use of public Wi-Fi networks (e.g., airports, cafes) without VPN is prohibited for any activity involving Confidential or Restricted data. Split-tunneling is disabled by default on the VPN to ensure all traffic is routed through Company security controls while connected.

9. Cloud and Third-Party Services

Employees must not sign up for or use third-party cloud services (SaaS tools, AI tools, file-sharing platforms) for Company business without prior approval from IT and Procurement via the New Vendor/Tool Request process, which includes a mandatory security and data privacy assessment. This applies specifically to generative AI tools: employees may only use the Company-approved and vetted GenAI platforms for work purposes, and must never input Confidential or Restricted data (including customer data or source code) into any unapproved AI tool.

10. Incident Reporting

Any suspected security incident, including malware infection, unauthorized access, data breach, or lost device, must be reported immediately to the IT Service Desk (available 24/7) and the Security Operations Center via the internal Incident Reporting Portal. Employees should not attempt to investigate or remediate a suspected incident themselves, as this can interfere with forensic evidence; the SOC will lead the response and communicate next steps within 1 hour of report for critical incidents.

11. Network and Physical Security

All VPT office locations use badge-based access control, and employees must not allow “tailgating” (letting an unbadged person follow them through a secure door) under any circumstances. Visitors must be signed in at reception and escorted by their host at all times. Printed Confidential or Restricted documents must be collected immediately from shared printers and disposed of via secure shredding bins, never regular waste bins.

12. Enforcement

IT Policy violations are reviewed by the IT Security team in coordination with HR and, where warranted, Legal. Minor first-time violations (e.g., a single unauthorized software installation) typically result in a written warning and mandatory retraining, while serious violations (e.g., data exfiltration, willful bypass of security controls) may result in immediate termination and referral to law enforcement where applicable. These policies are reviewed annually by the Chief Information Security Officer and updated as the threat landscape and regulatory environment evolve.